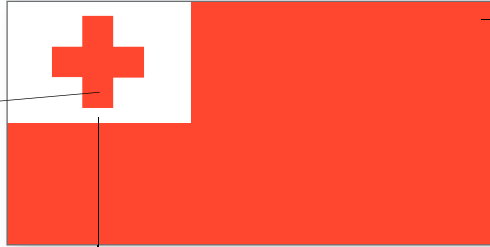


Tonga

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** November 4, 1875 **Usage:** National and Civil

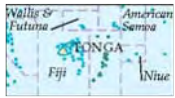
The red cross represents the king's devotion to Christianity



Red represents the blood Jesus shed on the cross

White symbolizes purity

Australasia and Oceania



Tonga was unified under King George Tupou I in 1820. In 1900, it became a British protectorate before regaining its independence in 1970.

The flag dates from 1862 when the king at the time, who had converted to Christianity in 1831, called for a national flag which would symbolize the Christian faith.

A NEW "CHRISTIAN" FLAG

The first design was a plain white flag with a red couped cross, but this was later found to be too similar to

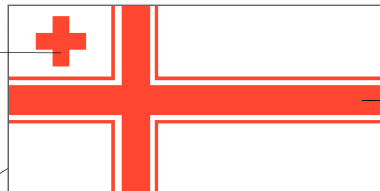
the International Red Cross flag, adopted in 1863, and so the white flag was placed in the canton of a red one. The cross and the red color signify the sacrifice of Christ's blood. The 1875 constitution states that the flag shall never be altered.

The naval ensign, introduced in 1985, also has a red couped cross on white in the canton.

TONGAN NAVAL ENSIGN

Red couped cross in the canton

The naval ensign, introduced in 1985, recalls the flag of Imperial Germany



A red, cotised or bordered, Scandinavian cross